MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025

Third SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG3DSEFDG200 - FASHION FUNDAMENTALS AND DESIGN CONCEPTS

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation (Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Short Answers

Answer any 10 questions

Each question carries 2 marks

1. **What does the term pret-a-porter mean?** [K] / [CO1]

   ANSWER: Prêt-à-Porter is a French word for Ready-to-Wear. Prêt-à-Porter is high-quality, factory-made fashion. These sets are available in a variety of sizes to accommodate a large number of consumers. While they differ in price and quality, the unifying feature is that these collections are designed within the limits of standardized sizing.

2. **What is mean by scale in proportion?** [K] / [CO2]

   ANSWER: Proportion is sometimes referred to as scale. Every design should be composed of shapes and spaces related without too great difference or too much similarity. No shape should be so dominant that all others are insignificant, no background space should be entirely ignored.

3. **List out any four types of Colour harmonies.** [K] / [CO2]

   ANSWER: Monochromatic, Analogous, Complementary, Split-Complementary, Triadic, Tetradic, Square, Achromatic / Neutral.

4. **What is Draping?** [K] / [CO1]

   ANSWER: Draping is a fundamental technique in fashion design that involves skillfully manipulating cloth on a dress form to create garment prototypes. Unlike flat pattern-making, which begins with 2D designs, draping begins with a 3D approach, allowing designers to directly experiment with how cloth interacts with the body's contours and

movements. This hands-on approach allows designers to experiment with various folds, pleats, and shapes before finalizing the design through fabric positioning and pinning.

5. **How does Symmetrical balance differ from Asymmetrical balance?** [K] / [CO2]

   ANSWER: Symmetrical Balance (or Formal Balance) is achieved when both sides of a design are identical or very similar, essentially a mirror image, creating an impression of stability and formality. Asymmetrical Balance (or Informal Balance) is achieved when the two sides of a design are not identical, but they still appear visually balanced due to a careful arrangement of elements of different sizes, shapes, or colours. This approach offers more freedom of expression, creates intrigue, and is often used to correct the appearance of body irregularities.

6. **What do Vertical Lines represent in design?** [K] / [CO2]

   ANSWER: Vertical lines in design are used to convey a sense of strength, stability, and formality. They guide the eye up and down, which can visually elongate the figure, making the wearer appear taller and slimmer. In fashion and architecture, they reinforce the idea of power and structure due to their rigid, upright nature.

7. **Draw an emphasizing waistbelt.** [A] / [CO4]

   ANSWER:



8. **How do straight lines contribute to harmony?** [K] / [CO2]

   ANSWER: Straight lines contribute to harmony in a design by helping to establish a consistent direction or theme. Specifically, straight lines create a sense of structure and formality within the garment, which is a key component of the overall aesthetic. For unity to be achieved, these straight lines must work together and not against each other or other design elements, ensuring every part of the design supports the garment's purpose and overall aesthetic.

9. **What is Bridge in Womens Styling?** [K] / [CO1]

   ANSWER: Bridge" in women's styling refers to a category of fashion that bridges the gap between the high-end designer market and the more accessible mass-market retail. Also known as a "bridge line" or "diffusion line," it offers aspirational quality and design at a more moderate price point.

10. **Name the classification that divide the color wheel into two.** [K] / [CO2]

    ANSWER: The classification that divides the colour wheel into two is Warm and Cool colours.

11. **Who are Fashion followers?** [K] / [CO1]

ANSWER: Fashion followers are individuals who adopt new styles and trends after they have become popular, often influenced by fashion leaders, celebrities, and influencers. They typically prioritize fitting in with current styles and may lack the interest or time to be trendsetters themselves, opting for styles that are socially acceptable or widely promoted.

12. **Write any two accessories commonly used in men's wear?** [K] / [CO1]

ANSWER: Two common accessories for men's wear are watches and belts.

[2x10 = 20]

Part B

Long Answers

Answer any 5 questions

Each question carries 4 marks

13. **Differentiate between Hue and Chroma.** [U] / [CO2]

ANSWER: Hue is the property that defines the pure, basic color itself, giving the color its name, such as red, blue, or green; it essentially corresponds to the color's position on the traditional color spectrum, remaining constant regardless of whether the color is lightened or darkened. The term 'hue' tells you nothing about the color's vividness or how much gray it contains, focusing solely on the pure wavelength of light being perceived, and is the foundational element upon which all other color properties are built.

Conversely, Chroma defines a color's purity, intensity, or saturation, quantifying how bright, vivid, or free from gray a particular hue is. A color with high chroma is vibrant and pure (e.g., a rich, saturated blue), whereas a color with low chroma appears duller, muted, or closer to neutral gray (e.g., a desaturated, dusty blue), and is the key factor used by designers to create visual contrast and focal points in an outfit.

14. **Explain the challenges faced by ready to wear industry.** [U] / [CO1]

ANSWER: The Ready-to-Wear apparel industry currently faces significant challenges, primarily driven by the Fast Fashion business model. This model has intensified environmental issues like massive water pollution and textile waste, while also creating supply chain pressures that demand extreme speed and agility, often at the expense of quality and ethical labor practices. Economically, the industry is battling fierce price competition, complex inventory management issues resulting in frequent overproduction, and the struggle to meet consumer demands for both affordability and sustainability.

15. **Define the terms Classic and Fad in fashion with suitable examples.** [K] / [CO1]

ANSWER: A Classic is a style that possesses a timeless appeal and endures over a long period, remaining consistently fashionable due to its enduring elegance and simplicity, such as the little black dress or a crisp white shirt.

In contrast, a Fad is a temporary, popular trend that gains rapid and widespread popularity but has a very short lifespan, quickly rising and then declining just as fast, with examples including baggy trousers or harem pants.

16. **Describe the use of colour in creating Emphasis.** [U] / [CO2]

ANSWER: The use of color is a critical method for creating Emphasis in fashion design, as it functions to establish a focal point that captures and holds the viewer's attention. This is primarily achieved through contrast. By using colors that stand out against the surrounding areas such as a contrasting color or a highly saturated hue designers can make a specific part of the garment dominant in the visual hierarchy. For example, color contrast can be effectively used to emphasize the face area, which is the most unique and individualistic part of a person. Color is also instrumental in defining the Dominant elements (most visual weight) and Subordinate elements (least visual weight) of a design.

17. **Describe about Color theory.** [U] / [CO2]

ANSWER: Color Theory is a body of guiding principles used to understand the visual effects of specific color combinations and the rules of color mixing. All color is based on light and is organized visually using the Color Wheel. Every color is defined by three main properties: Hue (the pure color name, like red), Value (the lightness or darkness of the color), and Chroma (the purity or intensity of the color). Designers use these principles to select harmonious color schemes that evoke a specific mood or feeling in a design.

18. **Explain any two stages of Fashion cycle.** [U] / [CO1]

ANSWER: The fashion cycle moves through five distinct stages:(EXPLAIN ANY TWO)

1. **Introduction:** A new style is born through innovation. Styles are unique and expensive. Only fashion innovators and leaders wear them.
2. **Rise:** The style gains public visibility. Fashion leaders and trendsetters adopt it. Manufacturers increase production. Prices become more accessible.
3. **Peak:** The style reaches its maximum popularity. It is worn by the mass public. Mass production makes prices accessible to everyone. The trend is at its longest and most saturated stage.
4. **Decline:** Consumers grow tired of the style. Sales start to slow down. Retailers mark down prices to sell stock. Fashion followers are the last to wear the trend.
5. **Obsolescence:** The style is completely rejected. It is considered outdated and unfashionable. The cycle ends for that specific style. A new trend replaces it.

19. **List and briefly describe three types of Forms commonly used in Design or Fashion.** [U] / [CO2]

ANSWER: The three forms commonly used in design and fashion describe an object's three-dimensional nature (length, width, and depth) and are categorized by their visual characteristics:

Geometric Forms are precise, mathematical, and characterized by straight lines and sharp corners, creating structured silhouettes like A-lines or rectangles.

Organic Forms are irregular, curved, and free-flowing, reflecting shapes found in nature, and are used to create fluid, soft, or draped garments like cowl necklines.

Abstract Forms are a more complex and conceptual category that simplifies or distorts natural forms for artistic expression, often resulting in highly stylized, non-literal, or avant-garde fashion silhouettes.

20. **List any four Clothing Categories of Children's wear.** [K] / [CO1]

ANSWER: Children's wear is broadly categorized into functional groups that account for a child's activities and developmental stage. Four common clothing categories include.

Casual Wear (everyday, durable clothes like T-shirts, shorts, and jeans), Outerwear (garments worn for warmth and protection, such as jackets, coats, and hoodies), Sleepwear (soft, comfortable clothes specifically designed for night-time, like pajamas and nightgowns), and Formal Wear (structured apparel like suits and elaborate dresses for special occasions).

[4x5 = 20]

Part C

Essay

Answer any 3 questions

Each question carries 10 marks

21. **Discuss various types of Silhouettes in Fashion. Describe how style complements each one.** [U] / [CO1]

ANSWER:

1. **Sheath silhouettes:** Silhouette which hugs the body from top to bottom. This silhouette looks best on the women with no too few curves and is generally recommended by slimmer women with well-defined waist.
2. **A-line silhouette:** The silhouette resembles the capital A which is fitted at top and flares at the skirt. This garment flatters mostly every body type. Garment of this type is narrow at the top and gradually widens towards the hem smoothing out the lines. It best fits every body type
3. **Hourglass Silhouette:** Hourglass Silhouette means fitted at the waist. These silhouettes can be designed using belts, darts, waistbands. This type of silhouette best fits the people with narrow waistlines and is used to emphasize the curves of the body.
4. **Empire silhouette:** The silhouette with raised waistline. It is fitted top garment and flares under the chest. It is best suited with people not having defined waist. It should be avoided by hourglass and can be worn by both pear and apple figures
5. **Bell or Ball gown silhouette:** The Ball Gown or Bell-Shaped dress is generally fitted till waist and gradually widens towards hemline forming a shape like bell-shaped skirt. This style is flattering on almost any body

type, but is especially flattering for petite women, or those with small waists. On a pear-shaped woman, the full skirt can do much to camouflage large hips.

22. **Describe the classification of texture.** [U] / [CO2]

ANSWER:
1.Real or actual or tactile texture: is the real thing. It is the actual way a surface feels when it is felt or touched, such as rough, smooth, soft, hard, silky, slimy, sticky, etc. 3-D art such as sculpture and architectural structures are tactile because they can be felt
2. Visual or implied texture: Texture: This type of texture is created through visual cues, such as lines, shapes, colors, and patterns, to give the impression of texture without the actual physical feel. Artists use techniques like shading, cross-hatching, and stippling to create the illusion of texture on a two-dimensional surface.

23. **Give an example of a complementary color scheme and sketch an outfit using it. (ILLUSTRATE ANY PAIRS FROM COMPLEMENTARY COLOR SCHEME)** [A] / [CO3]

ANSWER: A complementary color scheme uses two colors that are positioned directly opposite each other on the traditional color wheel. This pairing creates the highest possible contrast, making both colors appear more vibrant and intense when placed side-by-side.



24. **Explain the classification of Costumes into Traditional, National and Ceremonial types with examples.** [U] / [CO1]

ANSWER: The different types of cultural clothing can be grouped based on their context and function, reflecting a group's heritage, identity, or ceremonial needs.

Traditional Costumes, such as the Indian sari, Japanese kimono, Scottish kilt, and Mexican huipil, are outfits that represent the cultural heritage and customs of a specific group or region, often having been worn in daily life in the past or reserved for cultural festivals today.

National Costumes are specific outfits, often drawn from traditional wear like India's Sari and Kurta Pajama or the Scottish Kilt, that are recognized as official symbols of a nation or ethnic group, serving as a unifying identity and typically worn on important occasions like national days.

Ceremonial Costumes are special clothes, such as an Indian bridal saree, a Christian wedding gown, or the Kathakali dance costume, that are worn only during specific important rituals, formal occasions, or religious events and are imbued with symbolic meaning relevant to the ceremony itself.

25. **Explain in detail rhythm in the context of design Principles.** [U] / [CO2]

ANSWER: The principle of Rhythm in design refers to the visual movement created by the repetition or arrangement of design elements such as colour, line, or texture within a garment. Its primary function is to guide the viewer's eye smoothly and purposefully across the entire outfit, creating a sense of flow, energy, and continuity. By creating tempo and pattern, rhythm ensures the design is dynamic and aesthetically pleasing.

Rhythm can be established through various techniques and arrangements:

- Repetitive Rhythm (Regular Rhythm): This is the most basic and common type, involving the repeated use of a design element like a motif, shapes, pleats, trims, or a consistent colour throughout the garment.
- Alternation Rhythm: This occurs when two or more elements are repeated in a regular, alternating pattern, adding visual interest and variety to the design without disrupting balance.
- Progressive Rhythm (Gradation): This technique creates rhythm through a gradual increase or decrease in a design element, such as a change in size, colour, shape, or spacing, which draws the eye in a smooth, directional way from one part of the garment to another.
- Transition Rhythm: Achieved through the smooth and continuous flow between different elements, often utilizing curved lines, soft draping, or a gradual blending of colours (such as ombré fabric) to move the eye naturally across the garment.
- Fluid or Flowing Rhythm: This is created by the harmony of related curves and folds that lead the eye effortlessly throughout the entire costume, with skilful draping, such as in a sari, being a typical example.
- Broken or Random Rhythm: Broken or random rhythm occurs when design elements are repeated in an irregular, unexpected, or scattered way. Unlike repetition or alternation, this type of rhythm does not follow a predictable pattern. It creates a sense of surprise, modernity, or artistic flair.

[10x3 = 30]

AMANDA SIMON
Assistant Professor
KMM College of Arts and Science, Thrikkakara